

Main and secondary energy/fuel type for lighting

Table 11.13 : Household Numbers and Percentages by Main and Secondary Energy/Fuel Type for Lighting, 2024

Energy/fuel type	Main source		Secondary source	
	Number	Percentage	Number	Percentage
Total	6,111,315	100.0	6,111,315	100.0
Electricity - National grid/Rural hydro power project	5,987,585	98.0	7,323	0.1
Kerosene lamp	95,150	1.6	2,789,215	45.6
Solar power (grid connected)	8,093	0.1	23,548	0.4
Solar power (standalone)	5,817	0.1	27,598	0.5
Other*	14,670	0.2	40,628	0.7
No secondary source	-	-	3,223,003	52.7

*Other- this category includes Biogas, Generator and Other ‘-’ Not relevant

According to Table 11.13, the primary source of energy used for lighting in Sri Lanka is electricity supplied through the national power grid/Rural hydro power project, with 98.0 percent of households relying on this source. Although only 1.6 percent of households report kerosene as their main source of lighting, a considerably higher proportion (45.6%) use kerosene as a secondary source. It is noteworthy that, in certain instances, the secondary source reported may represent an alternative source utilized when the primary source is unavailable. Furthermore, 52.7 percent of households do not report the use of any secondary source of lighting energy.

Table 11.14 : Percentage of Households Using Electricity and Kerosene as the Main Sources of Lighting, by Residential Sector, 2012 and 2024

Sector	Electricity		Kerosene	
	2012	2024	2012	2024
Sri Lanka	87.0	98.0	12.2	1.6
Urban*	96.8	98.6	3.1	0.7
Rural	85.2	97.9	13.8	1.7
Estate- Rural **	79.9	96.6	19.2	2.9

*Although the 2024 census collected information separately as urban and estate urban, here the two categories are combined and shown as urban.

** In the 2012 Census, the sector was identified as “Estate”, whereas in the 2024 Census it is referred to as “Estate Rural”.

According to Table 11.14, the percentage of households using electricity was 87.0 percent in 2012, which grew by 11 percentage units by 2024. Conversely, the use of kerosene decreased significantly from 12.2 percent to 1.6 percent, reflecting a decline of 10.6 percentage units over the same period.